ATTACHMENT ALCHEMY®

Attachment Patterns, Healing Vectors & Wise Adult Qualities

A PRACTICE GUIDE FOR ATTACHMENT REPAIR

ATTACHMENT PATTERNS: WAVE, ISLAND, MIXED & ANCHOR

Wave
More fluid, emotionally expressive, and relationally oriented.

GROWTH DIRECTION
Build structure, boundaries, and an internal anchor while staying open and connected.

Island
More self-contained, independent, and protection-oriented.

GROWTH DIRECTION
Soften into connection, receive support, and let others in while maintaining self.

Mixed
A blend of wave and island patterns, often with openness and protectiveness — and a lot of fear of connection.

GROWTH DIRECTION
Build flexibility — learning to stay connected and self-resourced, with more choice and regulation.

Anchor
A more secure, integrated and stable way of relating (our North Star).

QUALITIES
Relationally open, internally stable, self-connected, and able to move with life's waves together with others.

Wise (Ideal) Adult Qualities

Safety & Protection
The child feels safe with a caregiver.

Attunement
Responsiveness & validation to/of emotions. The child feels seen, known & cared for.

Soothing & Comfort
The child feels consistent comfort, soothing, reassurance and empathetic support.

Express Delight
The child feels valued for their being rather than their doing.

Support & Encourage Exploration & Making Mistakes
The child has someone safe to come back to that's encouraging & supports exploration.

The Six Healing Vectors for Attachment Repair

WAVE STRENGTH (Vectors 1–3)

Healing toward greater emotional aliveness, expression, and relational connection.

1	Shutdown / Mostly Thinking	→ FEELING → EXPRESSION	**WAVE STRENGTH** Energy moves. They feel and express what's true.
2	Isolation	→ RELATIONAL SUPPORT	**WAVE STRENGTH** Connection heals. They feel supported and less alone.
3	Nourishment Barrier	→ RECEIVING	**WAVE STRENGTH** They learn to receive care, love, and support.

ISLAND STRENGTH (Vectors 4–6)

Healing toward more internal safety, structure, capacity, and self-leadership.

4	Blended with Parts	→ WISE SELF / WISE PARENTS & UNBLENDED WITH PARTS	**ISLAND STRENGTH** They lead from wise self and relate to parts with love, not fusion.
5	Internal Collapse	→ INTERNAL STRUCTURE	**ISLAND STRENGTH** They build internal safety, capacity, and stability.
6	Parts Express in Daily Life	→ HEALTHY COMPARTMENTALIZATION	**ISLAND STRENGTH** Parts have their place. They show up consciously, not take over.

Become more resourced, integrated, and free to live and love from your Wise Self, riding the waves of life with more capacity and choice.

www.attachmentalchemy.org